

Firefly Festival



2-6 Players

60 Minutes

Ages 12+

Dusk settles over the archipelago and the first lanterns are lit. Build bridges between the islands, raise pagodas toward the sky and call the most spectacular festivals the islands have ever seen. Whoever lights the night with the most dazzling celebration will earn glory - but the Sōrin are few, and the last lantern always comes sooner than you think.

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Rulebook version 10
Approximately 15 minutes per player



Overview

In Firefly Festival, players compete to build bridges between islands, raise pagodas toward the sky, and call the most spectacular festivals. Workers spread across the archipelago, and whoever lights the night with the most dazzling celebration will earn the greatest glory.

Each turn you take one **Main Action** - building bridges, raising pagodas, moving your workers, holding festivals or taking coins - and you may add one **Secondary Action**: completing a goal or playing a Lucky Fish. When the festivals run out, the player with the most points wins.

Components

Common Components



1 Game Board - double sided: one side for 2-3 players, the other for 4-6



15 Sōrin tokens - placed on top of pagodas to mark scoring



50 coins



18 island tiles



36 public goal cards (68 mm × 45 mm) - 6 types of 6 cards



50 private goal cards (68 mm × 45 mm)



30 unique player power cards (80 mm × 120 mm)

Per Player



20 bridge tokens



12 stackable pagoda floors



12 meeples



3 fish tokens



1 score marker



2 player aid cards (80 mm × 120 mm)

The Archipelago

Islands and water lanes in the middle, the score track around the edge, and the goal displays along the bottom



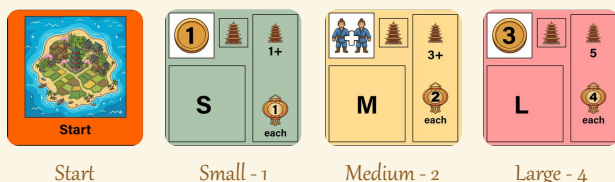
Setup

- Place the board in the centre of the table, the correct side up for the player count.
- Take a number of island tiles based on the player count:

Island Size	2-3 Players	4+ Players
Start (Orange)	1	2
Small (Green)	5	6
Medium (Yellow)	3	6
Large (Red)	3	4
Total	12	18

- Draw the starter island spaces at random** - **one** on the 2-3 player side, **two** on the 4-6 player side - and place a starting tile on each. Any island space can be a starter, including one right in the middle of the map.
- Shuffle the remaining island tiles and randomly place them on the map.
- Select 4 public goal types from the 6 available. For each type, sort the 6 cards in ascending order (1 on top, 6 on bottom) and place the stack on a public goal space at the bottom of the board.
- Shuffle the private goal deck and place it face down on the marked spot on the board.
- Deal each player 2 Private Goal cards. Players may look at their own goals but must keep them secret from others.
- Place your starting workers** - how many depends on the number of starter islands, not on the player count:
 - One starter island** (2-3 player side): the starting player places **3 workers** on it, and each player after them places **one more** - so 3 and 4 at two players, and 3, 4 and 5 at three. Going later deserves a little something.
 - Two starter islands** (4-6 player side): every player places **4 workers**, 2 on each starter.

Unplaced workers wait in your supply - everyone owns 12 whatever their seat.



Pagoda reward, size, the height a festival needs, and points per piece. Two tiles per size - same score, different reward

- Each player receives 5 coins.
- Each player places their 3 fish in front of them.
- Place your score marker on the 0 space of the score track.
- Count out a number of Sōrin tokens based on the player count, shown below. Place them next to the main game board where everyone can easily see them. Return the remainder to the box.

Players	Sōrin
2	6
3	8
4	10
5	12
6	15

- Determine the first player randomly. Play proceeds clockwise.

Variant - Shifting Waters

For a different map every game, ignore the water rewards printed on the board. During setup, shuffle the water reward tokens face down and deal them onto the marked water spaces instead. Everything else plays exactly as normal.

Turn Structure

On your turn, choose exactly **one Main Action**. You may also perform **one Secondary Action**, either before or after your main action, but only once per turn.

The 5 Main Actions



Build a Bridge



Build a Pagoda



Move 3



Hold a Festival



Prosperity

The Secondary Actions



Complete a Public Goal



Complete a Private Goal



Use a Lucky Fish



Build a Bridge

Main Action

Bridges connect islands, allowing workers to move between them, and count toward a festival's bridge requirement and its scoring.

Bridges must be built in a **straight line** between two islands, with no turns or crossings.

To build a bridge, you must have a **worker on either island**.

Pay **1 coin per segment** of bridge. You must complete the entire bridge in one action - it is not permitted to only build part of a bridge. If you cannot afford to pay for the bridge, or you do not have enough bridge pieces left in your supply, then you may not build a bridge.

Bridges can **never be moved**.

Up to **3 bridges** can be built between a pair of islands, depending on the layout of the map. It is permitted for the same player to build multiple bridges between the same pair of islands.

Free Movement

After building a bridge, you may move any of your workers already on the two connected islands across the new bridge to the other island.

Water Rewards

Dotted around the map are rewards on water tiles. If you build a bridge piece on a reward, you immediately gain the reward.

Icon	Water Reward
	Gain 2 coins
	Recruit a new worker - place it on either of the two islands the new bridge connects
	Draw a new Private Goal
	Gain 5 points
	Gain 7 points

Pay first, collect after!

You gain the reward **after** building the bridge. You cannot use rewards gained by building a bridge to pay for it!



Move 3

Main Action

Moving around the board is very strategic - it gets you in the right place for festivals and for building.

As your main action, you may make **3 movements** of your workers. This can be the same worker 3 times, or 3 workers 1 time each, or any combination in between.

To move, trace a path from the worker's current location to their destination island. Workers only move along bridges. A chain of connected bridges belonging to a **single player** counts as **1 move**. This means that a network of bridges owned by the same player can let you travel a long distance with a single move.

If the bridges belong to you, there is no charge to use them. If the bridge belongs to another player, you must **pay them 1 coin for each bridge** you use - that is per bridge, the length of the bridge is not relevant. If you cannot afford to pay for moving, then you cannot move.

So a single movement is one of exactly two things: a run of any length through **your own** network, or the crossing of **one** rival bridge. Weaving out of your network, across a rival bridge and back into your network is **three movements** - your whole action.

Island Capacity

Each island has a capacity based on its size - Small: 4 workers, Medium: 5, Large: 6. It is forbidden to exceed this limit at the end of your turn. You may move through islands that are at capacity, but you may not stop. The island capacity is shown on the island tile.

Starter islands have no worker limit - any number of workers may stand on one. Nothing else in the game may ever push an island above its capacity.



Small



Medium



Large

Worked Example - moving and paying tolls

Kenji's first movement runs along his own network of three linked bridges, crossing four islands - because they are all his, that whole journey is **1 move** and costs nothing.

His second movement crosses one of Mei's bridges, so he pays **Mei 1 coin**, however long that bridge is. His third crosses another of hers for **1 more coin** - three movements spent, 2 coins paid.



Build a Pagoda

Main Action

Pagodas give you an immediate reward and are very important for festivals.

Pagodas are built on the designated spot on islands. Pagodas can **never** be built on the starting islands.

To build a pagoda, you must have a **worker on the island**.

Place your pagoda floor onto the island, or on top of any pagoda floors already on the island. Multiple players may contribute floors to the same pagoda - a pagoda can have pieces from many different players.

Pagodas have a **maximum height of 5** - you may never place a sixth piece on a pagoda.

Building a pagoda is **free**. Each island has a pagoda reward shown on the island. As soon as you build the pagoda floor, immediately claim the reward shown on that island:

Icon	Pagoda Reward	Island
	Gain 1 coin	Small
	Gain 2 coins	Small
	Recruit 2 new workers - see below	Medium
	Draw a new Private Goal	Medium
	Gain 3 coins	Large
	Gain 4 coins	Large

Where your new workers land

Recruited workers join the island you have just built on, **while it has room** under that island's capacity - counting **every** player's workers, not just yours. Any worker that will not fit goes to a **starter island of your choice** instead, worker by worker.

So on a Medium island already holding 4 workers, one recruit joins it and the other goes to a starter island. If it already holds 5, both do.

When a Festival is held, a Sōrin marker is placed on top of that island's pagoda, sealing it permanently - no further floors may ever be added to it.



Hold a Festival

Main Action

Festivals are how you score most of your points in the game.

Keep an eye on the islands as the pagodas grow and the bridges multiply.

For a festival to be called, **all three** of these requirements must be met:

- **Minimum pagoda height.** Each island has a minimum number of pagoda floors that must be placed before a festival can be called. This is displayed on the island: Small 1, Medium 3, Large 5.
- **Enough bridges.** The number of bridges connecting to the island must equal or exceed the height of the pagoda.
- **A worker present.** You must have a worker on the island - someone has to run the show!

You do **not** need to be the strongest player on the island. Being outnumbered there does not stop you calling its festival - one worker of yours is enough. Remember though that everybody scores their own pieces, so calling a festival from behind hands your rival more points than it hands you.

Count bridges, not neighbours

A 4-segment bridge counts once, exactly as a 1-segment bridge does, and **every owner's** bridges count toward the requirement - not just yours.

Because up to 3 bridges may connect the same pair of islands, doubling up a crossing you already have is a perfectly good way to serve a taller pagoda.

Festivals can never be held on a **starter island**, and an island that has already hosted one is sealed with a Sōrin and can never host another. If all the requirements are met, we hold a festival! Scoring one is described on the next page.



The lanterns are lit and the whole archipelago comes to watch

Scoring a Festival

Immediately place a **Sōrin token** on top of the island's pagoda to indicate it has been scored. The island cannot be scored again and no more pagoda pieces can be added to the island.

Points are now awarded to every player for every worker, pagoda floor and bridge they have on the island - for bridges, it is per bridge; the length of the bridge is not relevant. Each island displays its point value: **Small 1, Medium 2, Large 4**. Every piece scores that many points for its owner.



The Firefly Bonus

Next, we award the firefly bonus! For every worker on the island, the person who called the festival gains **2 points**. In addition, look at every other island directly connected to the festival island by a bridge - the person who called the festival gains **2 points** for every worker on those islands as well.

No points are awarded for workers near the festival island but not directly connected to it - they couldn't enjoy the fireworks without standing on a bridge.

Finally, any player who has a worker on the island takes back all their Lucky Fish - see **Use a Lucky Fish**.

The last Sōrin

One way the game can end is if all the Sōrin tokens have been placed. If the Festival places the last Sōrin, the game ends at the end of the current player's turn and we proceed to final scoring - see **End of the Game**.



SCORING

- 1

All players score for each component they have on the island.


+

+

each

- 2

The Host scores 2VP for every worker on the island on connected adjacent islands.


- 3

Cap the Pagoda. It cannot score again.


- 4

Anybody who participated in the Festival takes back all their Lucky Fish.



The player aid repeats this sequence

Worked Example - a Medium island festival

Mei calls a festival on a Medium island with a point value of **2**. Its pagoda is 3 floors tall, 3 bridges reach the island and Mei has a worker there - every requirement is met.

Island scoring: Mei owns 2 workers, 2 pagoda floors and 1 bridge there: $5 \text{ pieces} \times 2 = 10 \text{ points}$. Kenji owns 1 worker, 1 pagoda floor and 2 bridges: $4 \text{ pieces} \times 2 = 8 \text{ points}$.

Firefly bonus (caller only): 3 workers stand on the island (Mei's 2 and Kenji's 1) and 2 more workers stand on islands directly connected by bridge: $5 \text{ workers} \times 2 = 10 \text{ points}$ for Mei.

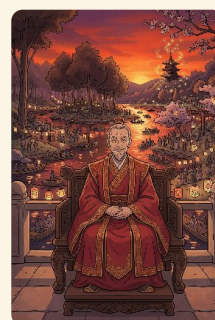
Mei scores $10 + 10 = 20 \text{ points}$; Kenji scores 8. Both had workers at the festival, so both take back all their Lucky Fish. Mei then places a Sōrin token on the pagoda, and that island is finished for the rest of the game.

Half of it is the fireflies

Notice that the firefly bonus is a full half of Mei's score. That is the whole reason to be the one who calls a festival - everything else on the island is shared out to whoever owns the pieces.



Only the islands joined by a bridge share in the fireflies





Complete a Public Goal

Secondary

Public Goals are limited, but worth a lot of points. You should try to complete as many as possible!

At the bottom of the board are 4 public goals. Within each stack, the cards are arranged in increasing difficulty and also increasing rewards.

If you meet the requirements of the goal, you may claim it. Immediately gain the points shown on the card and put the card in your supply.

This immediately reveals the next card in the stack. It will have a similar goal, but of increased difficulty and reward.

One goal per turn

You may only claim **1 goal per turn**, even if you already meet the requirements of the new goal revealed.



Every festival needs somebody to fund it



Complete a Private Goal

Secondary

Private Goals are a way of scoring a lot of uncontested points. Try to score Private Goals on turns where you might not be able to complete a public goal.

Each player is given 2 private goals at the start of the game. On your turn, if you have met the requirements of the card, you may complete it and gain the points shown on the card. The card's points are the whole reward - there is no bonus on top.

You do **not** draw a replacement card. The only way of getting new Private Goals is through the rewards gained by building bridges and placing pagodas.

Remember, you may only claim **1 goal per turn** - see **One goal per turn** opposite.



Kept close, revealed only when scored

Summary of Goals

Four of these six public goal types are used each game - the card shown is always the easiest of its stack of six



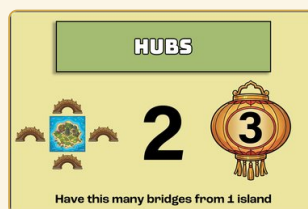
Empire

Pagodas on different islands



Architect

Bridges of increasing size



Hubs

Many bridges from one island



Merchant

Have lots of money



Tower

Build tall pagodas



Diversity

Workers on many islands



Private Goals

Secret - two at setup



Prosperity

Main Action

Some nights the lanterns can wait, and the purse cannot.

As your main action, take **3 coins** from the bank. That is the whole action - you do nothing else with it.

Your **Secondary Action** is **unaffected**. You may still complete a goal or spend a Lucky Fish in the same turn, exactly as normal.

There is no limit on how often you may take Prosperity, and no limit on how many players may take it in the same round.

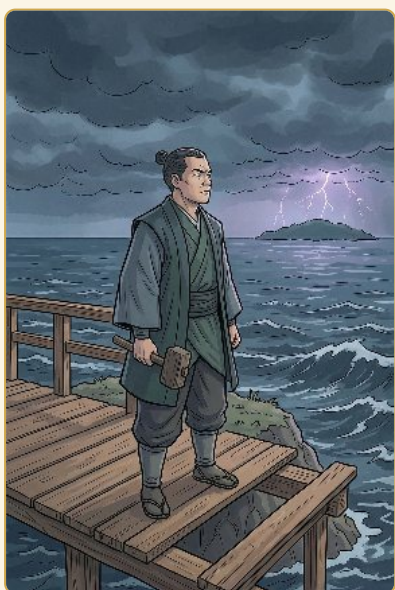
The rescue, not the plan

Prosperity is deliberately small. Three coins buys a short bridge or one crossing of a rival's - it is what you take on the turn when nothing else is affordable, not a strategy in its own right.

Worked Example - digging yourself out

Kenji has 2 coins. The bridge he wants is 4 segments, his workers are stranded behind one of Mei's bridges he cannot pay the toll on, and no pagoda is tall enough to celebrate. Every other action is closed to him.

He takes **Prosperity** for 3 coins. Because his Secondary Action is untouched, he also completes the private goal he has been holding for two turns. Next turn he has **5 coins** - enough for that bridge, and enough to be back in the game.



Use a Lucky Fish

Secondary Action

Fish are considered lucky, and playing them at the right time can change the game dramatically - but they are expensive!

Each player starts the game with 3 fish in front of them. As a secondary action, you may place one of your fish on the next slot of **the Palace**. These slots are not blocking - many players can be on the same slot.

You must immediately pay the price shown on the slot. If you are unable to pay, you may not place your fish. The price of placing fish increases with each fish - **3 coins**, then **4 coins**, then **5 coins**.

If you do not have any fish in your supply, you may not take this action.

After placing your fish, you may immediately perform **one main action**: Build a Bridge, Build a Pagoda, Move 3, or Hold a Festival.

The fish is your secondary action

Using your Lucky Fish counts as your Secondary Action. You may not also complete a goal this turn.

A fish buys one **main action**, not a whole extra turn - and it may not buy Prosperity. Paying 3 coins to gain 3 achieves nothing.

Whenever you have a worker on an island where a festival is held, regardless of who calls the festival, you take **all your fish** back into your supply. This is true even if somebody else called it - so standing where a rival is about to celebrate has its compensations.



The Palace, where the fish are offered



 End of the Game

Be watchful as the pagodas rise and the Festivals are held. The game could end sooner than you realise.

The end of the game is triggered when **any** of the following events happen, and the game then ends at the conclusion of the current player’s turn:

- The last Sōrin is placed and a festival is held - score the festival as normal.
- A player places their last pagoda piece.
- All the public goals are completed.

Island Group Scoring

Each player then counts the **largest group of islands joined together by their own bridges**. There is no route to trace - a group is simply every island your bridges hang together, however the network branches, and passing through an island twice is fine. If your bridges form separate groups, only the largest counts.

Islands, 12-island side	4	6	8	9	10	12
Islands, 18-island side	6	8	10	11	12	14
Points scored	5	10	15	20	30	40

A smaller group scores nothing, and a group between two rungs scores at the lower one. The player with the **largest group** of all scores an additional **15 points**, and if two players tie for it, both score it.

Victory!

The player with the most points wins. If there’s a tie, the player with the most coins wins. If there’s still a tie, players rejoice in their shared victory.

 Unique Player Powers

Unique player powers give the game a new twist and challenge you to play the game in different ways.

Once you are familiar with the game, you may like to play with unique player powers. Shuffle the deck of powers at the start of the game and deal each player 2 cards. Each player secretly selects one card and discards the other. Players then reveal their cards and read out their powers for the other players.

Most cards have an ongoing power, but some cards alter the starting resources in a player’s supply.

Thirty ways to celebrate

The powers reward very different plans - some want a sprawling bridge network, others a single towering pagoda or a full purse. Listen carefully as they are read out, because your rivals’ powers hint at where they are heading.

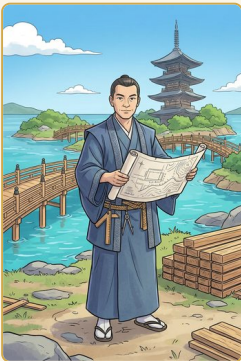


One last night of lanterns before the tally

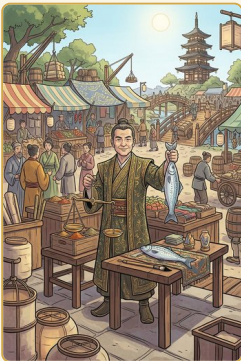
A Few of the Powers - deal two, keep one, reveal it to the table



The Ferryman



The Architect



The Merchant



The Lantern Maker

Quick Reference

Your Turn

One **Main Action**, plus optionally one **Secondary Action** before or after it.

Main Actions

- **Build a Bridge** - worker on either island; pay 1 coin per segment; straight lines only; collect water rewards after building; free movement across the new bridge.
- **Build a Pagoda** - worker on the island; free; maximum height 5; never on starter islands; claim the island's pagoda reward immediately.
- **Move 3** - three movements; your own connected network is 1 free move; a rival bridge is its own movement at 1 coin to its owner; respect island capacity (4 / 5 / 6) at the end of your turn.
- **Hold a Festival** - minimum pagoda height (1 / 3 / 5); bridges at least equal to pagoda height; your worker present. No majority needed.
- **Prosperity** - take 3 coins; your Secondary Action is still yours.

Secondary Actions

- **Complete a Public Goal** - claim the revealed card of a stack you satisfy.
- **Complete a Private Goal** - play a private goal you satisfy; no replacement drawn, no bonus.
- **Use a Lucky Fish** - pay 3 / 4 / 5 coins to the Palace, then immediately take a main action (not Prosperity).

Only **one goal per turn** may be claimed, and the Lucky Fish uses up your secondary action.

Festival Scoring

- Seal the pagoda with a Sōrin token - that island is finished.
- Every player scores the island's point value for each worker, pagoda floor and bridge they own there - **Small 1, Medium 2, Large 4**.
- The caller gains 2 points per worker on the island and on every island directly connected by a bridge.
- Everyone with a worker present takes back all their Lucky Fish.

Game End Triggers

- The last Sōrin is placed by a festival.
- A player places their last pagoda piece.
- All public goals are completed.

Finish the current player's turn, then score.

Final Scoring

- Score your largest **group** of islands joined by your own bridges - 12-island side 4 / 6 / 8 / 9 / 10 / 12, 18-island side 6 / 8 / 10 / 11 / 12 / 14, both paying 5 / 10 / 15 / 20 / 30 / 40 points.
- The largest group of all gains a further 15 points.
- Most points wins; ties are broken by the most coins.

Firefly Festival

Icon Key



Coin



Points



Worker



Bridge



Pagoda floor



Sōrin token



Festival



Public goal



Private goal



Prosperity

Lucky Fish
(the Palace)

Recruit workers

Light the lanterns, ring the bell, and let the fireflies decide.